

Showers 58/29 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 45/38 B20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

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Kennedy Center may get ‘Trump’ in its name

BY KELSEY ABLES, JANAY KINGSBERRY, DAN DIAMOND AND TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

The board of the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts voted on Thursday to rename the storied arts institution the “Trump Kennedy Center,” an unprecedented change for the U.S. presidential memorial that drew swift condemnation from Kennedy family members and Democratic leaders.

The Kennedy Center confirmed the vote in an email to The Washington Post. The law establishing the building designates it as the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts.

“The Kennedy Center Board of Trustees voted unanimously today to name the institution The Donald J. Trump and The John F. Kennedy Memorial Center for the Performing Arts,” said Roma Daravi, the center’s vice president of public relations, in an email. “The unanimous vote recognizes that

SEE KENNEDY CENTER ON A17

Hard-line plan for Mexico morphed into boat strikes

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA, ALEX HORTON AND DAN LAMOTHE

President Donald Trump’s homeland security adviser, Stephen Miller, and other senior officials were looking for a fight.

In the first months of the administration, Miller, the architect of Trump’s anti-immigration and border policies, and his team discussed starting a new war on drugs by striking cartels and alleged traffickers in Mexico, according to one current and two former U.S. officials.

Reducing the power of cartels, an idea that dated back to the first Trump administration, would ease the flow of migrants and narcotics, creating early political wins. But as the administration surged thousands of U.S. troops to the southern border, increased U.S. surveillance flights and

SEE STRIKE ON A6



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

This article is by Lizzie Johnson, Kostiantyn Khudov, Anastacia Galouchka, Serhiy Morgunov and Carolyn Van Houten

KRYVYI RIH, UKRAINE — At the moment Russia launched the nearly four-ton ballistic missile, an 8-year-old Ukrainian boy was running across a playground.

The missile was an Iskander 9M723, fresh off an assembly line in Votkinsk, where workers in the Russian heartland plug American technology into the bellies of guided weapons, despite sanctions and export controls, Ukrainian investigators have found.

By late 2025, Russia had launched more than 400 of the Iskander-M rockets. This one, which took flight on April 4, was

A Russian missile, filled with U.S. tech, rips a Ukrainian boy’s life apart

Despite export controls, weapons with Western components show up on Ukrainian soil nightly, killing and maiming civilians

Matviy Holovko plays at the Superhumans Center, which treats war victims, in Vynnyky, Ukraine. The 8-year-old lost his arm in a Russian missile attack on a playground in April. It was declared the war’s single largest confirmed casualty of Ukrainian children.

the 64th of the year. The Kremlin claimed that it was targeting a meeting of military officials at a restaurant, though surveillance footage showed only civilians there.

The boy was second-grader Matviy Holovko. His hometown of Kryvyi Rih, an industrial hub where Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky grew up, suffered such frequent bombardment that he’d grown used to sleeping in the hallway. Matviy couldn’t remember life before the full-scale war that started when he was 5. He knew how to identify the roar of missiles and drones before he could tie his shoes or write his name.

On this Friday evening, the

SEE UKRAINE ON A10

Trans care for minors targeted

PROVIDERS WOULD LOSE U.S. FUNDING

Proposal by HHS could mean big cuts to access

BY PAIGE WINFIELD CUNNINGHAM

The Trump administration is moving to broadly curtail gender transition care for young people, proposing Thursday to eject medical providers from major federal health insurance programs if they provide services including hormone therapy or procedures such as mastectomies to children and teenagers.

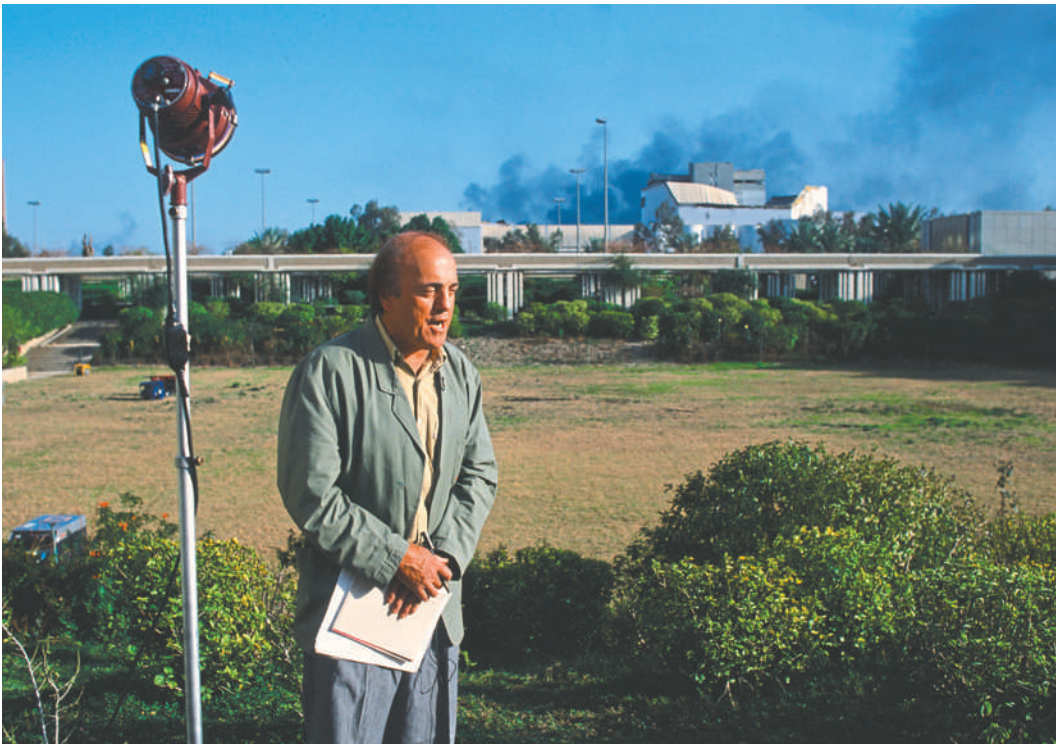
The rules, if finalized, could result in a wide-scale contraction of the availability of transition services for children. As the single largest payer for health care in the United States, the federal government has enormous sway over hospitals, clinics and doctors’ offices, which rely heavily on reimbursement from Medicare and Medicaid. The proposed regulations would prevent those providers from receiving funding for any type of medical visit if they also offer youth transition care.

“We are done with junk science driven by ideological pursuits, not the well-being of children,” said Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., who said at a news conference that he signed a declaration Thursday saying that “sex-rejecting procedures pose medical dangers of lasting harm on children who receive these interventions.”

The new regulations, which still need to be finalized, would also ban Medicaid and the Children’s Health Insurance Program from paying for transition care for those under 18 and 19, respectively.

The American Civil Liberties Union said it will sue over the new regulations if they’re finalized. And Democratic state officials issued statements hinting at possible legal clashes. New York Attorney General Letitia James (D) vowed to “use every tool at my disposal to fight this proposal and protect transgender Americans and their families.”

SEE FUNDING ON A17



KAVEH KAZEMI/GETTY IMAGES

Pulitzer-winning war correspondent

Peter Arnett, shown during the 1991 Gulf War, covered multiple conflicts over a career that began in the 1950s. Arnett, 91, won a Pulitzer Prize for his coverage of the Vietnam War. **Obituary, B16**

Shutdown clouds sunny Nov. inflation report

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

Inflation cooled unexpectedly in November, although economists cautioned that gaps in the data make it too early for the White House to declare victory.

The November consumer price index reported that prices rose at a 2.7 percent rate from a year earlier, cooler than the most recent reading from September, according to new data from the Labor Department on Thursday.

“Core” inflation, the rate without volatile food and energy costs, increased at an annual rate of 2.6 percent, an improvement from September.

That kind of cooling reflects the best inflation report since President Donald Trump took office. However, unlike prior inflation reports, this one lacked data, especially many of the month-to-month changes in inflation in certain sectors, due to the six-week government shutdown that prevented data collection in October.

Economists said the headline figures were likely skewed lower by quirks in how the report was compiled, with several noting that officials did not begin gathering prices until the second half of November — a period that may have captured Thanksgiving discounts without fully reflecting higher prices earlier in the month, when promotions are typically scarcer.

SEE INFLATION ON A15

Brown shooting suspect found dead at storage site

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK, DANIEL WU, PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM AND ANDREW JEONG

A man suspected in the deadly shooting at Brown University has been found dead Thursday evening in a New Hampshire storage facility, authorities said.

“We’re motivated by the victims and survivors of this horrific

ic incident,” Ted Docks, FBI Special Agent in charge of the Boston field office, said at a news conference. “Even though the suspect was found dead tonight, our work is not done. There are many questions that need to be answered. There’s a lot of evidence that needs to be processed.”

The body of 48-year-old Claudio Manuel Neves Valente, a

former Brown graduate student and Portuguese national whose last residence was in Miami, was found with a satchel and two firearms, after FBI agents executed a search warrant.

Providence Police Chief Col. Oscar L. Perez Jr. said that Valente acted alone as far as authorities know. Law enforcement officials have also not released

SEE BROWN ON A7

IN THE NEWS

Trump’s left-wing crackdown A bid to root out what the administration sees as domestic terrorism may put speech under scrutiny. **A2**

Coast Guard hate policy The service deleted language that called swastikas and nooses “potentially divisive” and said that their prohibition remains in effect. **A2**

THE NATION
As some in the GOP break ranks, Speaker Mike Johnson says he still has firm control. **A3**
The president will use \$2.6 billion in housing aid to pay for his \$1,776 “warrior dividend.” **A17**

THE WORLD
A hotel in the Philippines said the alleged Sydney gunmen stayed there for weeks. **A13**
The U.S. announced \$11 billion in proposed arms sales to Taiwan, angering China. **A13**

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A Trump family company is merging with a fusion power firm to develop the energy source, raising ethics concerns. **A14**
PayPal, hoping to increase its loans to small businesses, has submitted applications to set up its own bank. **A14**

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A new documentary looks at the complicated legacy of the crime reality show “To Catch a Predator.” **B1**
SPORTS
Trump’s move to take over D.C.’s public golf courses via a default notice meets sharp criticism from lawmakers. **B7**

THE REGION
The federal government admitted failures by the Army and air traffic controllers in a January crash near Reagan National Airport. **B13**
After years of discussions, Maryland is advancing a plan to build a new, eight-lane Chesapeake Bay Bridge. **B13**

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